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**Evaluating Text Messaging as a Contact Strategy and Predictors of Text Message Consent:
Evidence from the Census Household Panel**

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Abstract

As data collection efforts face concerns about declining response rates and rising costs associated with participant recruitment and follow-up, further research is needed to understand how different contact strategies may benefit survey researchers confronting these challenges. Text message invitations present an opportunity for data collection efforts – especially longitudinal efforts with repeated contact – to adopt a potentially faster and less expensive contact strategy compared to other commonly-used contact strategies (e.g., mail, in-person visits, telephone).

This study extends the literature by using nationally representative data from a unique data source: the Census Household Panel (CHP). The CHP was a probability-based nationwide survey panel that regularly fielded surveys to panel members as monthly “topicals”. Once enrolled, panelists were invited to the topical surveys via email and text messages. Panelists must provide a mobile phone number and consent to receive text message invitations. This research uses paradata and survey responses from the May 2024 topical (i.e. Topical 7) with approximately 10,000 respondents to explore the impacts of text messaging. More specifically, we examine four central research questions: (1) How do text message reminders contribute to response in the topical 7 survey?; (2) Are there demographic differences in who clicks on the survey through text message invites versus email invites?; (3) What are the consent rates for receiving text messages?; and (4) Are there demographic differences in who consents to receive text messages? Insights from this research help extend the field’s knowledge and understanding of the impacts of sending text message invitations.

Findings from this research show that: (1) text message invitations appear to contribute to survey response by bolstering initial response rates in the hours immediately following receipt of these text messages; (2) there are demographic differences by age, race/ethnicity, education level, family income, and respondent type in the propensity of panelists to access a survey through text message invitation; (3) text message consent rates for Topical 7 of the CHP are comparable to the existing literature (i.e. ~50%); and (4) there are demographic differences by race/ethnicity, age, family income, educational attainment, marital status, region, and respondent type in panelists’ consent behaviors. In sum, this paper’s findings suggest that the use of text messages as a contact strategy is advantageous for reaching certain demographic groups and is a promising tool for increasing response rates to national data collection efforts.

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1. INTRODUCTION

As U.S. Census Bureau surveys are modernizing and adding internet self-response data collection to historically interviewer-administered surveys, better understanding the impacts of mixed-mode contact strategies becomes even more vital for encouraging response. Best practices in contact strategy designs emphasize the necessity of using multiple modes (i.e. mail, email, text messages, phone calls) to invite and remind potential respondents to complete the survey to boost response rates (Dillman et al. 2014; Millar and Dillman 2011). While postal mailing invitations add authenticity and legitimacy to the survey request (Dillman et al. 2014), they are not as timely as electronic contact modes and are more costly. Electronic contact modes, such as emails and text messages, provide opportunities for reaching respondents more quickly and may better signal the time sensitivity of the request.

While emails and text messages both provide the advantages of speedy delivery, text messages provide a few advantages over emails for web surveys. First, text messages can be perceived as more immediate or time-sensitive than emails. This has been reflected in studies that have shown response comes more quickly via text message invites than via other types of contact modes (Mavletova and Couper 2014). This is particularly important for sequential multimode surveys as they try to push respondents to complete in the less expensive mode – web – and for those with shorter field periods, like the Current Population Survey. Gathering responses on the web quickly before progressing to the next mode produces savings in nonresponse follow-up in a more costly survey mode.

Using text messages can provide other advantages over sending emails. Cell phone numbers provide additional alternative contact information for cases where the email address was not recorded accurately. Text messages may also be beneficial for potential respondents who do not regularly check their emails or pay close attention to their emails. Similarly, text messages may be advantageous in cases where potential respondents do not have email accounts or where potential respondents ignore or overlook contact attempts via email (e.g., when emails are thought to be spam) (Cabrera-Álvarez and Lynn 2023). Spam filters or inbox rules can be set up to filter messages from senders not known to them – sometimes by the email service and not by the user themselves. While some spam filters exist for text messages, they tend to be used less and require more deliberate set-up by the user than email spam filters.

Despite this, text messages do have some drawbacks. First, text messages do not offer as much space to build rapport or convey a message to persuade the potential respondent to complete the survey as a letter or an email (Hansen and Pedersen 2012; Mavletova and Couper 2014). Additionally, text messages may reach people at times when they are unavailable to respond or in a place where it is not easy to respond (i.e. in a public setting where they are uncomfortable responding or unable to due to accessibility to the internet). Finally, some studies have shown lower response rates from text messages indicating that text messages may not necessarily be

an efficient contact mode alone (see Hansen and Pedersen 2012). Further, requirements by the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) present additional considerations regarding the use of text messaging as a contact strategy for data collection efforts.

While the FCC has clarified that the Telephone Consumer Protection Act (TCPA) does not restrict the federal government (or contractors acting at its direction) from using autodialers or sending unsolicited text messages to cell phones in the conduct of official business (because the government is not considered a “person” under the Act) these exemptions do not apply to other survey organizations (Federal Communications Commission 2016). Private entities must comply fully with the TCPA when using texting as a contact method (Federal Communications Commission 2016). In addition, cell phone carriers and industry groups often impose their own rules: carriers may refuse to transmit large volumes of unsolicited texts, even if such messages are legally permissible, to protect their networks and subscribers (Federal Communications Commission 2016). These limitations restrict when and how text messaging can be used as a respondent communication strategy in survey operations. In practice, mass texting is almost always limited to opt-in lists of recipients (which is further constrained by the availability and accuracy of sample phone number information).

Government surveys have only recently begun to use text message invites and reminders. For example, the Household Pulse Survey (HPS) invited potential respondents to complete their survey via text message starting in 2020. Other examples of government surveys that have used text messages include more specialized populations, such as the National Survey of College Graduates (Horwitz et al. 2024) and a survey of principals and teachers which used texting as a two-way survey response mode (Spiegelman et al. 2024).

As federal surveys continue to adopt web response and optimize survey instruments for mobile devices, understanding the impacts of implementing text message invitations and reminders becomes more important. According to Pew Research Center (2024), 91% of Americans own a smart phone, including 15% of Americans who depend upon smartphones for their internet use and have no home broadband service. With high smartphone ownership rates and increasing technology use, text message invitations have the potential to reach a large portion of Americans who can actively complete the survey on their devices. Furthermore, reaching those who rely upon smartphones for their internet use is particularly important for response as Americans who are younger (ages 18-29), not White, have lower incomes, and have lower levels of educational attainment are more likely to be smartphone dependent (Pew Research Center 2024).

This study uses Census Household Panel data to examine who consents to receiving text message invitations and reminders, how text message reminders impact response, and who is responding to email and text message reminders. Findings from this study can help inform future contact strategies for federal surveys, particularly those that are longitudinal in nature, and can give us insight on how this type of data collection scheme may look for others who incorporate text messages in a longitudinal design.

2. BACKGROUND

2.1 Impact of sending text messages invites and reminders on response

Research so far suggests that text message invitations and reminders do not appear to substantially impact overall response rates (Christian et al. 2024). In an experiment comparing email invites and reminders to text message invites and reminders, de Bruijne and Wijnant (2014) did not find a significant difference in the response rate by the invitation type for their panel respondents. Similarly, in an experiment comparing postal, telephone, and text message recruitment in Denmark, Hansen and Pedersen (2012) found the initial response rates before reminders were sent were lower for those receiving text message invites versus telephone invitations, but no difference with postal mailings.

However, Horwitz et al. (2024) found in an experiment comparing unsolicited text only invitations versus text message and email invitations for the Census Bureau's Household Pulse Survey that the text only contact strategy resulted in a slightly higher response rate overall and higher response amongst younger age groups and females than the email and text message contact strategy.

Studies have shown that response to text message invites does occur rapidly, which makes text message invites an important tool for gaining responses. This rapid response is important for surveys that use sequential mixed-mode design by lowering the costs associated with nonresponse follow-up in another mode or for surveys with short field periods. For example, Christian et al. (2024) found that sending earlier text messages in the data collection period (vs. later in data collection) resulted in respondents completing the survey more quickly, which meant fewer respondents required follow-up reminders in the mail. McGeeney and Yan (2016) noted that 15% of the panelists who responded did so within 30 minutes when both an email and text message invitation was sent versus 6% when only an email invitation was sent. Andreadis (2020) found that half of the survey links in a text message reminder that were clicked occurred within one hour, including 25% that occurred within about 3.5 minutes of the text message reminder delivery.

2.2 Consent to Text

Currently the Census Bureau only sends text message invitations and reminders to those who have previously consented to be texted when they provide their mobile phone numbers. In a longitudinal design this means the Census Bureau can collect the individuals' mobile phone number and obtain their consent for future text messages in their initial interview or survey completion and send invites and reminders for later survey periods. Prior work has shown consent rates for text messages to be around half of respondents. In a study on Pew Research Center's American Trend Panel, about 54% of their respondents consented to text message (McGeeney and Yan 2016). In a panel study in the Netherlands that conducts weekly online questionnaires, 59% of smartphone users provided their mobile phone number when asked to consent to receiving text message for a main questionnaire invitation (de Bruijne and Wijnant

2014). Among a survey of teachers and principals, Spiegelman and Zotti (2021) found that about half of the principals and teachers who provided their cell phone numbers consented to receive text messages.

Prior studies have found that those who do consent to receive text messages differ demographically from those who have not consented to receive text messages. McGeeney and Yan (2016) found that text message consenters in Pew Research Center’s American Trend Panel tended to be younger, have higher incomes, live in urban areas, and more likely to be non-White or Hispanic than those who did not consent. There were not any statistically significant differences between consenters and non-consenters by sex or education. Similarly, Spiegelman and Zotti (2021) found that non-White or Hispanic principals and teachers were more likely to give their cell phone number and consent to receive text messages than White principals and teachers. Interestingly, higher likelihood of providing a cellphone number and consent to text also increased with age for these principals and teachers. De Bruijne and Wijnant (2014) did not find any significant differences in providing a phone number for text message consent by sex, age or education in their study in the Netherlands. Horwitz et al. (2024) found in an experiment for the National Survey of College Graduates that those who consented to be texted were older, more likely to be White, and had higher levels of educational attainment.

Obtaining consent to send text message invites, especially among subgroups that have traditionally had lower self-response rates, is important for ensuring invitations and reminders are effective in encouraging response. Evaluating the share of respondents who consent to future text messages and how these respondents may differ from those who do not consent is valuable for developing and implementing effective contact strategies.

3. RESEARCH QUESTIONS

The Census Household Panel data used for this study did not include an experimental design. This study is an exploratory study that examines the following four research questions (RQ):

RQ1: How do text message reminders contribute to response in the Topical 7 survey?

RQ2: Are there demographic differences in who clicks on the survey through text message invites versus email invites?

RQ3: What are the consent rates for receiving text messages?

RQ4: Are there demographic differences in who consents to receive text messages?

4. METHODOLOGY

4.1 Data

We use data from the Census Household Panel (CHP) recruitment survey and the Topical 7 survey. Invitations for the recruitment survey were distributed via postal letter that included a \$5 prepaid incentive to encourage participation. The recruitment survey was administered September 12 to October 10, 2023, in English and Spanish, and the first replenishment operation was conducted from March 5, 2024, to April 9, 2024. Responding households received a \$20 cash incentive to complete the recruitment questionnaire. Participants could complete the web questionnaire in Qualtrics or call to complete the questionnaire on the telephone. There was also a nonresponse follow-up outbound telephone operation. A total of about 18,500 respondents completed the recruitment surveys.

Once enrolled, panelists are invited to respond to monthly topical surveys via emails and/or text messages. Up to 4 emails and 4 text messages are sent each month, inviting the panelist to respond to the survey via the web or telephone. Outbound telephone operations are conducted for select cases. Participants received a \$10 incentive upon the completion of their survey.

The Topical 7 survey was administered from May 21 to June 4, 2024. Table 1 shows the sample size, number of respondents, and response rates for recruitment and Topical 7 surveys. The sample for the Topical 7 survey was about 18,500 respondents who completed the recruitment survey¹ and a total of about 10,000 responded to the Topical 7 survey. The weighted response rate (AAPOR RR2) for Topical 7 was 10.2% (American Association of Public Opinion Research 2023).

Table 1. Sample Size and Response Rates for Recruitment and Topical 7 Surveys

	Sample Size	Number of Respondents	Response Rate (Percent) of Data Collection	Overall Response Rate
Recruitment sample	105,000	18,500	17.6 (Unweighted) 18.3 (Weighted)	17.6 (Unweighted) 18.3 (Weighted)
Topical 7	18, 500	10,000	53.9 (Unweighted) 55.8 (Weighted)	8.5 (Unweighted) 10.2 (Weighted)

Note: Sample Sizes and Number of Respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Survey.

Analyses in this paper use the Topical 7 survey because this was the first topical survey sent to those who had been enrolled in the CHP from the 2024 replenishment operation. This enabled us to examine differences in consent and usage of text message invitations to compare between newly recruited members of the panel and existing members of the panel. Data about the completion of the Topical 7 survey, including timing of completion and how they completed

¹ Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded throughout the paper to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protections.

(via an email or text message link), was used in the analysis. In addition, information from the recruitment survey was merged with the Topical 7 survey, such as the respondent's demographic characteristics and whether the respondent provided a consent to text and phone numbers or email addresses to contact the respondent.

Table 2 shows the timing of the email and text message invites and reminders for the Topical 7 survey with the number sent for each invitation and reminder. On day 1 both an email and text message are sent. An email reminder is sent on day 3 to those who have not completed, and a text message reminder is sent on day 8 to those who have not yet completed. On day 10, both an email and text message are sent to those who did not yet respond, and another email and text reminder are sent on day 15 to those who had not yet responded.

Table 2. Topical 7 Invitation and Reminder Schedule

Day	Type of Invitation/Reminder	Time of Message
1	Email	6am ET
1	Text Message	12pm ET
3	Email	6am ET
8	Text Message	5pm ET
10	Email	6am ET
10	Text Message	12pm ET
15	Email	6am ET
15	Text Message	12pm ET

4.2 Measures and Analyses

For RQ1, paradata within Qualtrics enables us to identify when the response was completed and via which link: email or text message. We examine the timing of the response by which type of link was clicked. This analysis is descriptive in nature.

For significance testing for RQ2 and RQ4, this paper includes two main outcome measures. First, *clicking on text messages* is a binary measure of whether someone clicked on/accessed the survey through a text message invitation instead of an email invitation (0 = No; 1 = Yes). Second, *consent* is a binary measure of whether someone consented to receive text message invitations/reminders when enrolled in the panel (0 = No; 1 = Yes).

The analyses for RQ2 and RQ4 include a total of 9 control variables to account for compositional differences which may influence survey engagement and response behaviors. *Age group* is categorized into eight mutually exclusive categories: 18-24; 25-34; 35-44; 45-54; 55-64; 65-74; 75-84; and 85+. *Sex* is a binary variable denoting if respondents identify as male or female. *Race/ethnicity* is a nominal-level variable that consists of five mutually exclusive race/ethnicity groups: White, non-Hispanic; Black, non-Hispanic; Asian, non-Hispanic; Some other race/Multiracial, non-Hispanic; and Hispanic/Latino. *Marital status* is divided into now married, domestic partnership, widowed, divorced, separated, and never married. *Education level* is divided into five mutually exclusive categories: less than a high school diploma/GED; a high

school diploma/GED; some college; an associate's degree; a bachelor's degree; and a graduate degree. *Family income* consists of seven ordinal categories classifying respondents' annual family income: less than \$25K; \$25K-39.9K; \$40K-59.9K; \$60K-74.9K; \$75K-99.9K; \$100K-149.9K; and greater than or equal to \$150K. *Region* is a categorical variable denoting if respondents reside in the Northeast, Midwest, South, or West. *Language* is a binary variable denoting if the respondent completed the survey in English or Spanish. Lastly, *respondent type* is categorical variable classifying respondents as: regular responder (if they completed 5 or more topical surveys); irregular responder (if they completed 4 or fewer topical surveys); and replenishment sample member (if they were first included in Topical 7 as part of the replenishment sample).

Using Stata 18, descriptive statistics were calculated to establish Topical 7 response rates, consent rates (i.e. RQ3), and sample demographics. Chi-square tests of statistical significance were performed to identify bivariate associations between demographic variables and outcomes of interest (e.g., consent behaviors). Binary logistic regressions were performed to ascertain: (1) How do consent rates to receive text messages differ by respondent characteristics?; and (2) Who is clicking through on the text message invites versus the email invites? We present the odds ratios from these binary logistic regressions and interpret them as percent increases and percent decreases. For missing data, pairwise deletion is employed to preserve sample size across models depending on the outcome variable of interest. All analyses are based on unweighted data and we report significant differences at the 95%, 99%, and 99.9% confidence levels.

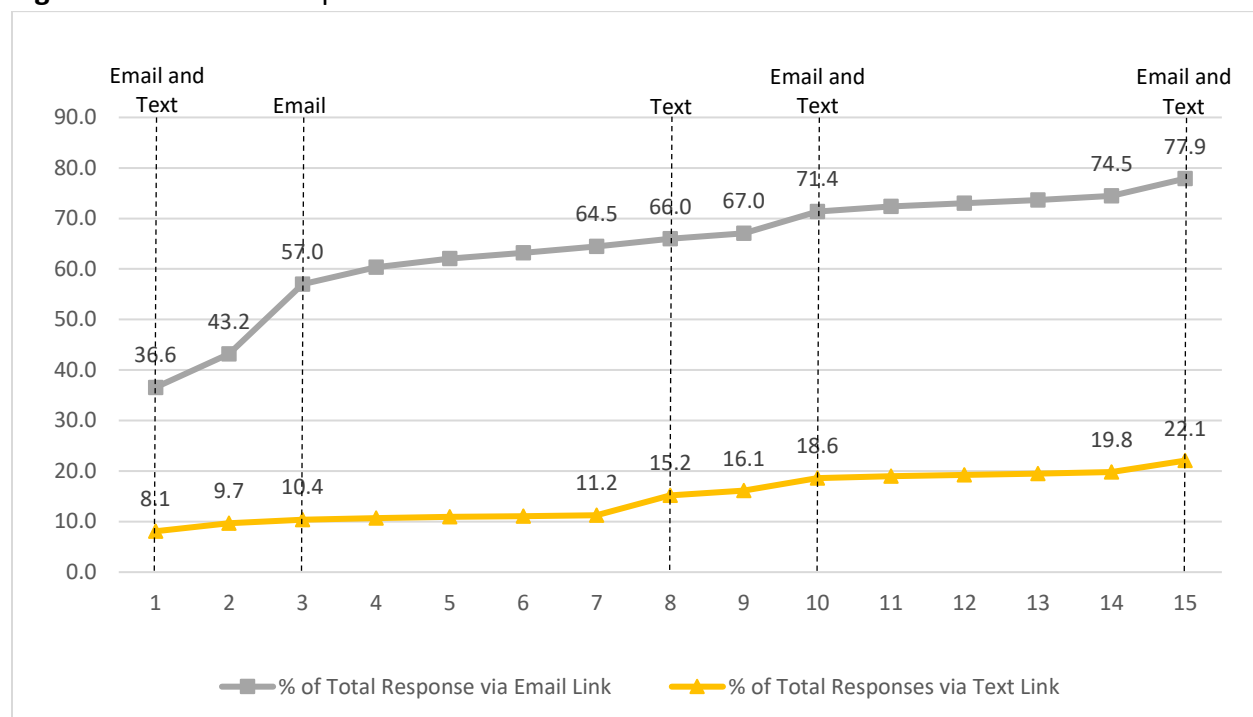
In the Appendix, we also include findings from supplemental analyses where we performed chi-square tests of significance for different consent behavior patterns (e.g., consent to receive neither texts nor emails, consent to receive only texts) by respondent demographics (Table A1) and then we performed binary logistic regressions to assess the influence of respondent demographics on specific consent behavior patterns (Tables A2-A4). For these analyses, the sample size is further restricted to respondents who provided phone number information as well as respondents who provided email information (where applicable).

5. RESULTS

RQ1: Response to Survey Via Text Message and Email Survey Links

In the Topical 7 survey, a majority of responses came from clicking on the email link (77.9%), compared with 22.1% that came from clicking on the text message link. Figure 1 shows the percent of response coming from the email and text message links throughout the 15-day survey period. Response from the text link grew most notably on days text messages were sent and remained relatively static on days without the text message reminders. By contrast, responses via email links grew most greatly on days when email reminders were sent, but response continued to come in steadily on days in-between email reminders.

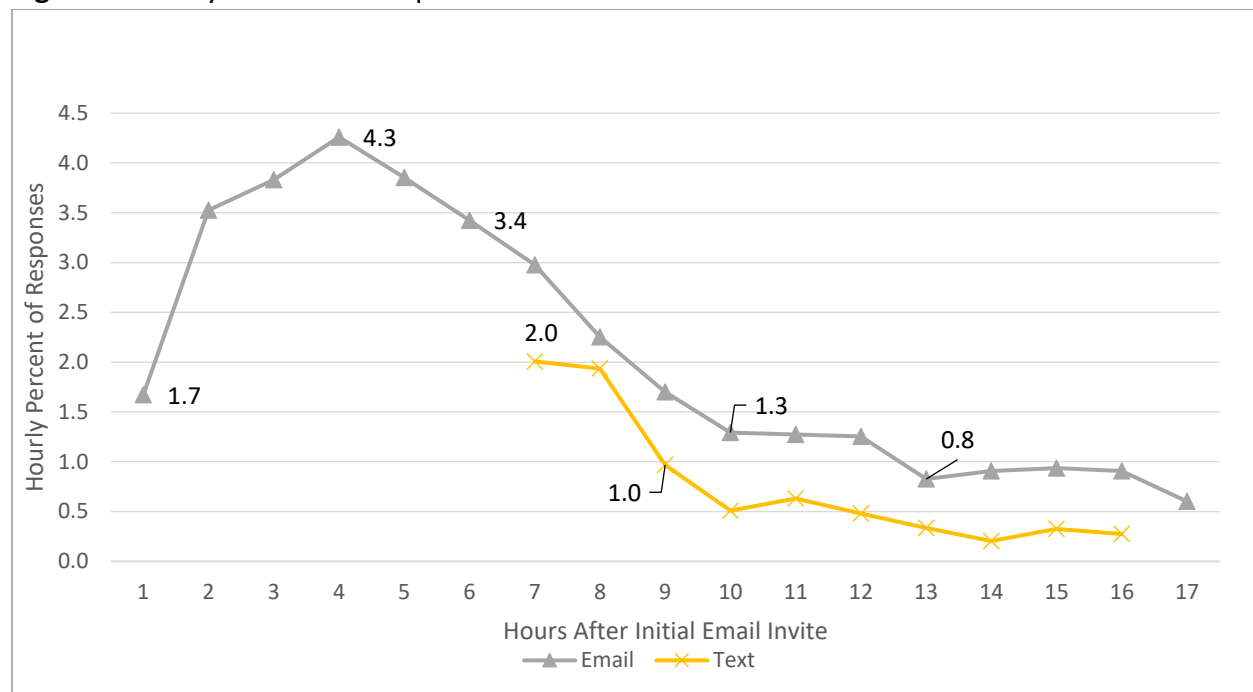
Figure 1. Percent of Responses from Email and Text Links



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Topical 7 Survey.

Figure 2 below shows the percent of total responses coming in the hours after the initial email invite, with the first text invite being sent 7 hours after the initial email invite. As expected, response to the first text message invite is returned quickly within the first hour or two after it was sent but declines sharply as the number of hours since the text message increases. By the third hour after the initial text message invite is sent, response reduces to about 0.5% or less over the next few hours. By contrast, response to the initial email invite takes a couple hours to increase and peak. In the first hour the email is sent, about 1.7% of responses come in and this spikes to 4.3% by hour 4. Response by email then declines steadily until hour 10 after the email is sent where it plateaus eventually dropping under 1.0%, about 13 hours after the email is sent. This plateau is also consistent with the time of the day when we might expect fewer responses as it enters the evening hours. However, it is important to note that the initial email invitations were sent earlier within the day (i.e. 6am ET) compared to text message invitations (i.e. 12pm ET), and this temporal ordering may account for some of the observed differences rather than differences in mode alone.

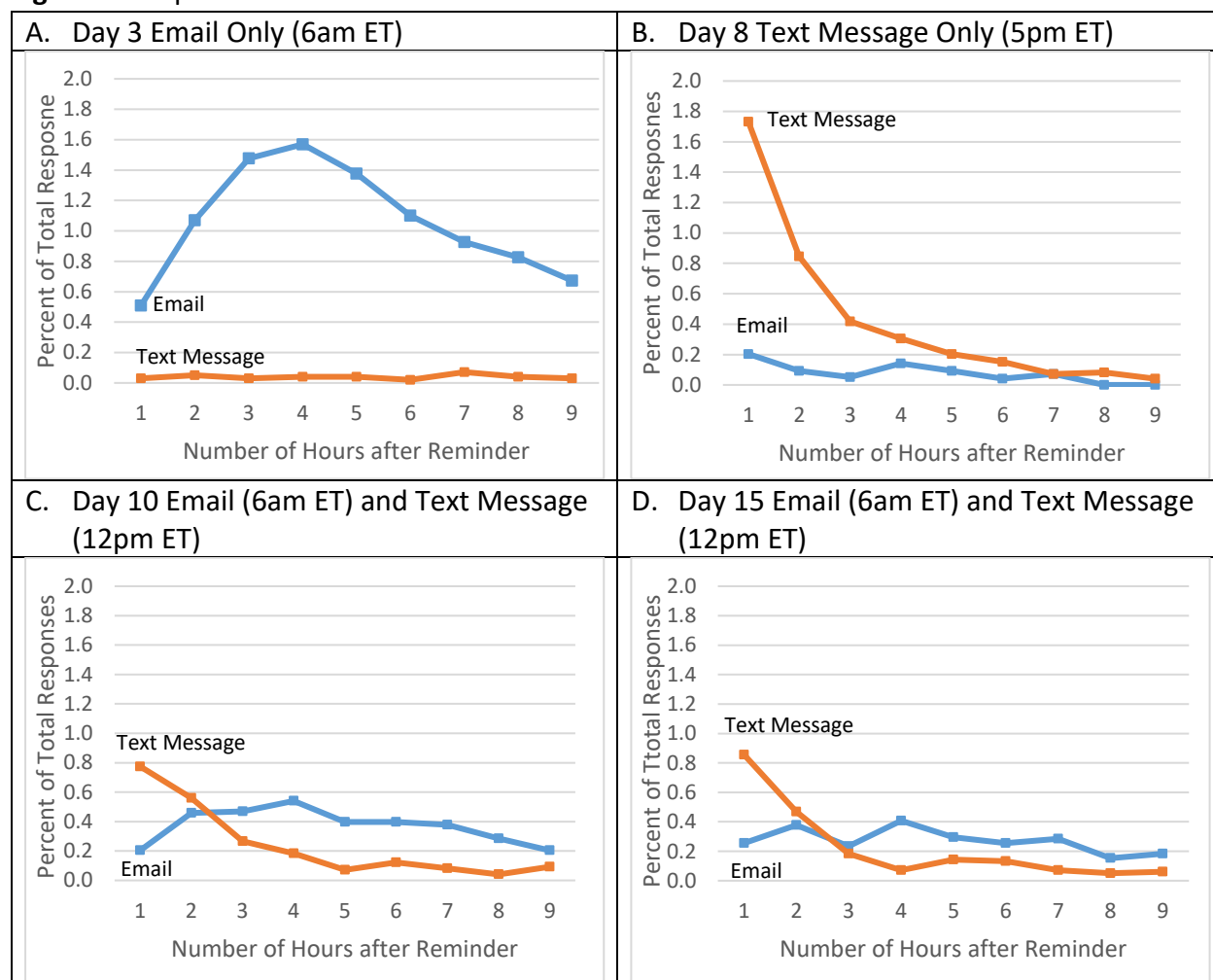
Figure 2. Hourly Percent of Responses from Email and Text Links after Initial Invites



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Topical 7 Survey.

Figure 3 below examines response after reminder emails and text are sent. When emails are sent alone (chart A), we see very few responses via the text message. Like the initial invite, it takes a couple hours for email responses to be returned and responses peak at about 4 hours after the invite is sent (about 10am ET/7am PT). On day 8, when a text message was sent in the afternoon/evening hours, the first hour produces quick response via text message and a notable amount of responses via the email link (see chart B). Charts C and D show days where emails and text messages were sent at 6am ET and 12pm ET, respectively. A common theme emerges where we see that text message reminders are associated with a sharp uptick in their response in the first hour, but drop off suddenly. By contrast, response coming from email reminders slowly increases in the first couple hours after the reminder is sent and then gradually tapers off over the course of the day. Since Chart C and D are depicting those who are responding later in data collection, these curves are smaller than earlier reminders in data collection.

Figure 3: Response After Reminder Emails and Texts are Sent



Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Topical 7 Survey.

RQ2: Characteristics of Text Message Responses

Tables 3-4 provide insight into: (1) the demographics of who is clicking on links sent via text messages (i.e. text links) versus who is clicking on links sent via emails (i.e. email links) (Table 3); and (2) the odds of a respondent clicking on text links over email links when taking into consideration all of the demographic variables (Table 4). Beginning with Table 3, we see that the demographic distribution of email and text respondents is fairly similar across each demographic measure. However, several descriptive differences do emerge. First, we see a greater share of racial/ethnic minority respondents clicking on text links versus email links. More specifically, 39.6% of those who click on text links identify with racial/ethnic minority groups versus 30.3% of those who click on email links. Beyond race/ethnicity, we also see descriptive differences by income and education, with a greater share of respondents with higher income or higher education clicking on email links versus text links. For example, 24.5% of those who clicked on an email link had a family income greater than \$150K whereas 19.5% of those who clicked on text links had a family income greater than \$150K. Similarly, 28.0% of

those who clicked on email links had a graduate degree versus 24.0% of those who clicked on text links. Significance testing via chi-square tests suggests that all of the demographic variables in Table 3 (with the exception of region) are statistically significantly associated with the distribution channel selected by respondents. In brief, Table 3 provides insight into how several key demographic characteristics differ descriptively by distribution channel – differences which we examine in a multivariate model in Table 4.

Table 4 outlines the odds ratios for a respondent clicking on text links over email links – taking into account all of the demographic measures outlined in Table 3. For clarity of interpretation, we discuss these odds ratios as % increases and % decreases. Looking at Table 4, we see several statistically significant differences emerge. First, consistent with the descriptive findings on race/ethnicity in Table 3, we see that identifying as Black, non-Hispanic or SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic is associated with a 53% increase and 48% increase respectively in the odds of clicking on text links over email links – compared to identifying as White, non-Hispanic ($OR = 1.53, p < 0.001$; $OR = 1.48, p < 0.01$). Similarly, compared to non-Hispanic White respondents, Hispanic/Latino respondents experience a 31% increase in the odds of clicking on text links over email links ($OR = 1.23, p < 0.05$). However, we do not see significant differences by the language that surveys are completed in (i.e. English or Spanish). Also mirroring findings from Table 3 are the findings by family income and education level. More specifically, we see evidence that those with lower family income or lower educational attainment are more likely to click on text links over email links. Compared to those with a bachelor's degree, those with less than a high school diploma and those with a high school diploma/GED experience a 48% increase and 24% increase in these odds respectively ($OR = 1.48, p < 0.05$; $OR = 1.24, p < 0.05$). Compared to those with a family income of >\$150K, we see that all income groups lower than >\$150K experience statistically significantly greater odds of clicking on text links over email links – with the exception of \$75K-99.9K where the association is non-significant ($OR = 1.11, p > 0.05$). As mentioned earlier, these significant findings corroborate the earlier discussion of descriptive trends in Table 3, where a greater share of respondents with higher income or higher education are observed clicking on email links versus text links.

Continuing with Table 4, we see several novel differences that were not initially noted in the discussion of descriptive findings in Table 3. First, we see a significant age effect, where increases in age are associated with decreases in the odds of clicking on text links over email links. More specifically, all age groups above 55-64 experience statistically significant decreases in these odds. Compared to those who are ages 55-64, respondents ages 65-74 experience a 21% decrease ($OR = 0.79, p < 0.01$), respondents ages 75-84 experience a 23% decrease ($OR = 0.77, p < 0.05$), and respondents ages 85+ experience a 47% decrease ($OR = 0.53, p < 0.05$) in the odds of clicking on text links over email links. Examining respondent type, replenishment sample respondents do not significantly differ from the regular responders who were already enrolled in the sample. However, irregular responders experience a 32% increase in the odds of clicking on text links over email links – compared to regular responders ($OR = 1.32, p < 0.01$). This finding appears to corroborate prior research showing that panelists with “irregular” response patterns are more likely to respond from text messages (Carbrera-Alvarez and Lynn 2024). Additionally, we observe one statistically significant coefficient for marital status – with

widowed respondents experiencing a 34% increase in the odds of clicking on text links over email links compared to now married respondents (OR = 1.34, $p < 0.01$). The reasoning for this singular difference for marital status is not immediately clear, but it is important to note that the sample size for widowed respondents is comparatively small – which may be influence findings in this instance due to statistical power. In brief, we do find evidence of demographic differences in who is clicking on text links versus who is clicking on email links, with race/ethnicity, family income, education level, age, respondent type, and marital status all being statistically significantly associated with the likelihood of clicking on text links over email links (as outlined above).

Table 3. Percent Distribution of Selected Variables (and Chi-Square Tests of Significance) by Distribution Channel for Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (N = 9,600)

	Email (n = 7,500)	Text (n = 2,100)
Age Category**		
<i>18-24</i>	2.1	2.1
<i>25-34</i>	12.6	13.7
<i>35-44</i>	18.1	19.9
<i>45-54</i>	16.5	17.8
<i>55-64</i>	20.3	21.2
<i>65-74</i>	20.6	17.5
<i>75-84</i>	8.4	6.9
<i>85+</i>	1.4	0.9
Sex**		
<i>Male</i>	44.5	41.1
<i>Female</i>	55.5	58.9
Race/Ethnicity***		
<i>White, non-Hispanic</i>	69.7	60.4
<i>Black, non-Hispanic</i>	9.7	14.5
<i>Asian, non-Hispanic</i>	6.8	6.4
<i>SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic</i>	3.1	4.4
<i>Hispanic/Latino</i>	10.7	14.3
Marital Status**		
<i>Now Married</i>	58.0	53.5
<i>Domestic Partnership</i>	5.2	5.9
<i>Widowed</i>	5.5	6.7
<i>Divorced</i>	13.0	13.9
<i>Separated</i>	1.4	2.1
<i>Never Married</i>	17.0	17.9
Education Level***		
<i>< HS Diploma</i>	2.1	3.7
<i>HS Diploma</i>	12.3	15.6
<i>Some College</i>	17.6	19.5
<i>Associate's Degree</i>	8.5	9.5
<i>Bachelor's Degree</i>	31.5	27.8
<i>Graduate Degree</i>	28.0	24.0
Family Income***		
<i><\$25K</i>	11.2	14.6
<i>\$25K-39.9K</i>	8.3	11.7
<i>\$40K-59.9K</i>	12.4	13.3
<i>\$60K-74.9K</i>	10.5	10.5
<i>\$75K-99.9K</i>	14.2	12.7
<i>\$100K-149.9K</i>	19.0	17.8
<i>>\$150K</i>	24.5	19.5

Region		
<i>Midwest</i>	25.0	22.7
<i>Northeast</i>	17.6	16.7
<i>South</i>	35.6	37.4
<i>West</i>	21.7	23.2
Language**		
<i>English</i>	98.4	97.5
<i>Spanish</i>	1.6	02.5
Respondent Type***		
<i>Regular Responder</i>	63.9	62.2
<i>Irregular Responder</i>	4.9	7.0
<i>Replenishment Sample Member</i>	31.3	30.9

Note: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; Percents may not sum to 100.0 due to rounding error; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

Table 4. Odds Ratios for Clicking on Links in Text Messages over Email by Select Demographics for Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (N = 9,600)

Age Category (55-64 ref.)	
18-24	0.91 (0.17)
25-34	1.08 (0.10)
35-44	1.08 (0.09)
45-54	1.05 (0.08)
65-74	0.79** (0.06)
75-84	0.77* (0.08)
85+	0.53* (0.14)
Sex (Female ref.)	
Male	0.96 (0.05)
Race/Ethnicity (White, non-Hispanic ref.)	
Black, non-Hispanic	1.53*** (0.12)
Asian, non-Hispanic	1.09 (0.11)
SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic	1.48** (0.19)
Hispanic/Latino	1.31** (0.11)
Marital Status (Now Married ref.)	
Domestic Partnership	1.02 (0.11)
Widowed	1.34** (0.15)
Divorced	1.00 (0.08)
Separated	1.17 (0.22)
Never Married	0.88 (0.07)
Education Level (Bachelor's Degree ref.)	
< HS Diploma	1.48* (0.23)

HS Diploma/GED	1.24*
	(0.10)
Some College	1.13
	(0.09)
Associate's Degree	1.15
	(0.11)
Graduate Degree	1.01
	(0.07)
Family Income (>\$150K ref.)	
<\$25K	1.35**
	(0.14)
\$25K-39.9K	1.60***
	(0.17)
\$40K-59.9K	1.24*
	(0.12)
\$60K-74.9K	1.23*
	(0.12)
\$75K-99.9K	1.11
	(0.10)
\$100K-149.9K	1.17*
	(0.10)
Region (South ref.)	
Midwest	0.93
	(0.06)
Northeast	0.98
	(0.07)
West	1.08
	(0.07)
Survey Language (English ref.)	
Spanish	1.02
	(0.19)
Respondent Type (Regular Responder ref.)	
Irregular Responder	1.32**
	(0.14)
Replenishment Sample Member	1.00
	(0.05)
Constant	0.21***
	(0.02)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses; *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; ref. = reference group; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

RQ3: Consent Rates for Receiving Text Messages

Table 5 provides insight into the share of panelists who consent to receiving text messages and provides phone number information. Looking at Table 5, we see that the overall text messaging consent rate for the analytic sample is ~52.6%, with ~5,000 respondents consenting out of ~9,500 respondents total. For Topical 7 of the CHP, the text message consent rate appears to be comparable to those documented in the existing literature (i.e. ~50%).

RQ4: Demographic Differences in Text Message Consent Behaviors

Tables 5-6 also provide insight into: (1) the demographics of who consents to receiving text messages and provides phone number information (Table 5); and (2) the odds of a respondent consenting to receive text messages when taking into consideration all of the demographic variables (Table 6). Beginning with Table 5, we see that the demographic distribution of who does or does not consent to receiving text messages is fairly similar across each demographic measure. However, several differences do emerge. First, we observe descriptive differences by income and education, with a greater share of respondents with lower income or lower education consenting. For example, 13.8% of those who consented to receive text messages had a family income less than \$25K whereas 10.8% of those who did not consent had a family income less than \$25K. Consistent with this, 20.4% of those who consented to receive text messages had a family income greater than \$150K, whereas 26.1% of those who did not consent had a family income greater than \$150K. We observe a similar education gradient where respondents reporting higher educational attainment compose a larger share of those not consenting compared to those consenting to receive text messages. More specifically, 54.8% of those who consented to receive text messages had a bachelor's degree or higher whereas 60.3% of those who did not consent had a bachelor's degree or higher. We also observe a potential sex disparity in Table 5, with 57.1% of those who consented identifying as female versus 54.9% of those who did not consent. Significance testing via chi-square tests suggests that all of the demographic variables in Table 5 (with the exception of language) are statistically significantly associated with respondents' consent behaviors though. In brief, Table 5 provides insight into how several key demographic characteristics differ descriptively by consent behavior – differences which we examine in a multivariate model in Table 6.

Table 6 outlines the odds ratios for a respondent consenting to receive text messages – taking into account all of the demographic measures outlined in Table 5. For clarity of interpretation, we discuss these odds ratios as percent increases and percent decreases. Looking at Table 6, we see several statistically significant differences emerge. First, consistent with the descriptive findings on family income and education in Table 5, we see that across all family income brackets, any family income below \$150K is associated with a statistically significant increase in the odds of consenting to receive text messages – with the exception of \$75K-99.9K where the association is non-significant ($OR = 1.11, p > 0.05$). Less stable are findings by education level. More specifically, while we saw preliminary evidence of higher education being potentially associated with lower odds of consenting, we see that both education above and below a bachelor's degree is significantly associated with increases in the odds of consenting. Compared to those with a bachelor's degree, those with a graduate degree and some college experience a

14% increase and 22% increase in these odds respectively ($OR = 1.14, p < 0.05$; $OR = 1.22, p < 0.01$). Yet, having an associate's degree is not significantly associated with these odds compared to those with a bachelor's degree – suggesting a potential nuanced education gradient and underscoring the importance of testing observed descriptive trends in multivariate models.

Continuing with Table 6, we see several novel differences that were not initially noted in the discussion of descriptive findings in Table 5. First, we see significant age effects, with mixed evidence on how increases and decreases in age are associated with the odds of consenting to receive text messages. For example, we see that most age groups above 55-64 experience statistically significant increases in these odds. More specifically, compared to those who are ages 55-64, respondents ages 65-74 experience a 15% increase ($OR = 1.15, p < 0.05$) and respondents ages 75-84 experience a 28% increase ($OR = 1.28, p < 0.01$). However, we also find that respondents ages 85+ experience a 40% decrease ($OR = 0.60, p < 0.01$) in the odds of consenting – suggesting a potential threshold effect. Additionally, we see that those ages 45-54 experience a 13% decrease in the odds of consenting to receive text messages ($OR = 0.87, p < 0.05$). Regarding race/ethnicity, we also see that (compared to non-Hispanic White respondents) non-Hispanic Black respondents experience a 28% increase in the odds of consenting ($OR = 1.28, p < 0.001$) while non-Hispanic Asian respondents experience a 25% decrease in the odds of consenting ($OR = 0.75, p < 0.001$) – suggesting that there may be racial/ethnic differences in who opts into receiving text messages. We also observe statistically significant associations by respondent type, with irregular responders experiencing a 62% decrease ($OR = 0.38, p < 0.001$) and replenishment sample members experiencing an 11% increase ($OR = 1.11, p < 0.05$) in the odds of consenting to receive text messages – compared to regular responders who were already enrolled in the panel. Lastly, we observe several isolated statistically significant coefficients for marital status and region. More specifically, respondents who are widowed (compared to those who are now married) experience a 43% increase in the odds of consenting ($OR = 1.43, p < 0.001$) and respondents from the Northeast (compared to respondents from the South) experience a 13% decrease in the odds of consenting ($OR = 0.87, p < 0.05$). However, we again need to be mindful of sample size (particularly for widowed respondents) and statistical power before we generalize from these findings – particularly given the lack of empirical support in the broader literature for theorizing differences by marital status and region. In brief, we do find evidence of demographic differences in who is consenting to receive text messages, with race/ethnicity, family income, education level, age, respondent type, marital status, and region all being statistically significantly associated with the odds of consenting to receive text messages (as outlined above).

Table 5. Percent Distributions of Selected Variables (and Chi-Square Tests of Significance) by Consent Rates for Receiving Text Messages for Respondents who Provided Phone Numbers in Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (N = 9,500)

	No (n = 4,500)	Yes (n = 5,000)
Age Category***		
18-24	2.1	2.0
25-34	13.0	12.6
35-44	19.8	16.8
45-54	18.0	15.3
55-64	20.4	20.5
65-74	18.2	21.9
75-84	6.9	9.6
85+	1.7	1.2
Sex*		
Male	45.1	42.9
Female	54.9	57.1
Race/Ethnicity***		
White, non-Hispanic	68.4	67.2
Black, non-Hispanic	9.5	12.1
Asian, non-Hispanic	8.1	5.5
SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic	3.2	3.6
Hispanic/Latino	10.8	11.7
Marital Status***		
Now Married	59.3	53.9
Domestic Partnership	5.0	5.6
Widowed	4.6	7.4
Divorced	12.4	14.1
Separated	1.3	1.8
Never Married	17.5	17.2
Education Level***		
< HS Diploma	2.4	2.7
HS Diploma	12.4	13.9
Some College	16.3	19.8
Associate's Degree	8.6	8.8
Bachelor's Degree	32.7	28.5
Graduate Degree	27.6	26.3
Family Income***		
<\$25K	10.8	13.8
\$25K-39.9K	8.1	10.2
\$40K-59.9K	12.0	13.1
\$60K-74.9K	10.1	10.8
\$75K-99.9K	14.0	13.4
\$100K-149.9K	18.8	18.3

>\$150K	26.1	20.4
Region*		
<i>Midwest</i>	24.4	25.1
<i>Northeast</i>	18.7	16.3
<i>South</i>	35.2	36.7
<i>West</i>	21.6	22.2
Language		
<i>English</i>	98.4	98.1
<i>Spanish</i>	1.6	1.9
Respondent Type***		
<i>Regular Responder</i>	62.5	63.5
<i>Irregular Responder</i>	8.0	3.3
<i>Replenishment Sample Member</i>	29.5	33.2

Note: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; Percents may not sum to 100.0 due to rounding error; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

Table 6. Odds Ratios for Consenting to Receive Text Messages by Select Demographics for Respondents who Provided Phone Numbers in Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (N = 9,500)

Age Category (55-64 ref.)	
18-24	0.90 (0.14)
25-34	1.00 (0.08)
35-44	0.88 (0.06)
45-54	0.87* (0.06)
65-74	1.15* (0.08)
75-84	1.28** (0.11)
85+	0.60** (0.11)
Sex (Female ref.)	
Male	0.98 (0.04)
Race/Ethnicity (White, non-Hispanic ref.)	
Black, non-Hispanic	1.28*** (0.09)
Asian, non-Hispanic	0.75*** (0.07)
SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic	1.13 (0.13)
Hispanic/Latino	1.12 (0.08)
Marital Status (Now Married ref.)	
Domestic Partnership	1.20 (0.12)
Widowed	1.43*** (0.14)
Divorced	1.07 (0.07)
Separated	1.37 (0.24)
Never Married	1.00 (0.06)
Education Level (Bachelor's Degree ref.)	
< HS Diploma	1.07

	(0.15)
HS Diploma/GED	1.11
	(0.08)
Some College	1.22**
	(0.08)
Associate's Degree	1.07
	(0.09)
Graduate Degree	1.14*
	(0.06)
Family Income (>\$150K ref.)	
<\$25K	1.45***
	(0.13)
\$25K-39.9K	1.30**
	(0.12)
\$40K-59.9K	1.21*
	(0.10)
\$60K-74.9K	1.19*
	(0.10)
\$75K-99.9K	1.11
	(0.08)
\$100K-149.9K	1.18*
	(0.08)
Region (South ref.)	
Midwest	1.00
	(0.06)
Northeast	0.87*
	(0.05)
West	1.03
	(0.06)
Survey Language (English ref.)	
Spanish	1.07
	(0.19)
Respondent Type (Regular Responder ref.)	
Irregular Responder	0.38***
	(0.04)
Replenishment Sample Member	1.11*
	(0.05)
Constant	0.85*
	(0.07)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses; *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; ref. = reference group; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

6. DISCUSSION

This paper aimed to answer four research questions using data from the Census Household Panel (i.e. a national panel survey): (1) How do text message reminders contribute to response?; (2) Who is clicking through on the text message invites versus the email invites?; (3) What are the consent rates for text messaging?; (3) What are the consent rates for receiving text messages?; and (4) How do consent rates differ by respondent characteristics?

Looking at how text message reminders contribute to survey response (RQ1), we observe rapid initial response when text message invitations are sent – consistent with prior literature. We also see that response declines sharply as the number of hours since text messages are sent increases. These findings suggest that text message invitations contribute to survey response by bolstering initial response rates in the hours immediately following receipt of these text messages.

This paper contributes to the available literature by quantitatively examining and documenting demographic differences in the likelihood of clicking on or accessing a survey through text invitation (as opposed to email) (RQ2). More specifically, this study documents demographic differences by age, race/ethnicity, education level, family income, and respondent type in the propensity of panelists to access Topical 7 of the CHP through a text message invitation. In sum, these findings suggest that certain sociodemographic characteristics are associated with greater propensity of panelists to click on text links as opposed to email links (and vice versa).

This paper also quantitatively documents consent rates for receiving text messages among enrolled panelists (RQ3). Looking at this paper’s findings, we observe text message consent rates for Topical 7 of the CHP that are comparable to the existing literature (i.e. ~50%). Further, this paper quantitatively examines and documents how these consent rates differ by respondents’ characteristics (RQ4). Consistent with the available literature, we find evidence of demographic differences in consent behavior (McGeeney and Yan 2016; Spiegelman and Zotti 2021; Horwitz et al. 2024). More specifically, this paper’s findings corroborate documented differences by race/ethnicity, age, and income. We also find novel differences by educational attainment, marital status, region, past response behaviors (e.g., regular vs. irregular responders), and survey language. However, while past research found no significant differences by select demographics (i.e. age, sex, education) in providing phone numbers for consenting to text messages (de Bruijne and Wijnant 2014), this study finds evidence of demographic differences in providing phone numbers for consenting to receive text messages.

There are several limitations that should be considered when evaluating the results from this research. First, all analyses presented are observational and exploratory in nature. Consequently, we cannot speak to causal relationships. Additionally, the data used for this paper come from a panel survey. Panelists may differ from other survey respondents in non-panel surveys in ways that are consequential for findings on text messaging as a contact strategy. Lastly, consenting to receive text messages does not necessarily mean that

respondents will receive text messages. For example, text message recipients can block or unsubscribe from receiving these messages that they previously consented to receive. Consistent with this limitation, prior research has shown that some demographic groups are more likely to block numbers (Christian et al. 2024).

Findings from this study indicate that text message invites were responsible for a substantial portion of responses. Compared to some contact modes, such as mail or interviewer-administered follow-up, it remains to be a relatively low-cost contact mode. This paper's findings suggest that the use of text messages as a contact strategy is advantageous for reaching certain demographic groups and is a promising tool for national data collection efforts to bolster initial survey response.

Future work may consider evaluating the use of text messages via an experimental design to investigate not only their effectiveness in encouraging response, but also the best time and day to contact potential respondents. In addition, further evaluation could examine the impact of text message invitations (and response to text message invites) by evaluating the data quality of responses to text message links and the impacts of device types that are used.

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Appendix A: Supplemental Analyses

Table A1. Percent Distribution of Selected Variables (and Chi-Square Tests of Significance) by Consent Behavior Patterns for Respondents who Provided Phone Numbers/Email Addresses in Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024

	Consent to Receive Neither (<i>n</i> = 850)	Consent to Receive Texts Only (Provided Phone Number) (<i>n</i> = 250)	Consent to Receive Emails Only (Provided Email) (<i>n</i> = 3,700)	Consent to Receive Both (Provided Phone Number and Email) (<i>n</i> = 4,800)
Age Category***				
<i>18-24</i>	2.0	2.6	2.1	2.0
<i>25-34</i>	15.5	9.8	12.5	12.8
<i>35-44</i>	24.3	20.7	18.8	16.6
<i>45-54</i>	17.9	14.9	18.0	15.4
<i>55-64</i>	17.9	22.9	20.9	20.3
<i>65-74</i>	14.3	19.3	19.0	22.1
<i>75-84</i>	6.1	7.3	7.0	9.8
<i>85+</i>	1.9	2.6	1.7	1.1
Sex**				
<i>Male</i>	42.7	36.0	45.6	43.2
<i>Female</i>	57.4	64.0	54.4	56.8
Race/Ethnicity***				
<i>White, non-Hispanic</i>	59.6	58.9	70.4	67.7
<i>Black, non-Hispanic</i>	9.7	18.6	9.5	11.7
<i>Asian, non-Hispanic</i>	10.8	4.0	7.5	5.5
<i>SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic</i>	5.1	4.0	2.8	3.5
<i>Hispanic/Latino</i>	14.8	14.6	9.9	11.6
Marital Status***				
<i>Now Married</i>	56.0	39.3	60.0	54.8
<i>Domestic Partnership</i>	5.0	5.1	5.0	5.6
<i>Widowed</i>	5.9	14.2	4.3	7.0
<i>Divorced</i>	13.4	16.4	12.1	14.0
<i>Separated</i>	2.3	2.9	1.1	1.7
<i>Never Married</i>	17.4	22.2	17.5	16.9
Education Level***				
<i>< HS Diploma</i>	4.3	7.6	2.0	2.4
<i>HS Diploma</i>	15.5	24.4	11.7	13.3
<i>Some College</i>	18.9	23.3	15.8	19.6
<i>Associate's Degree</i>	8.5	10.2	8.6	8.7
<i>Bachelor's Degree</i>	29.8	18.9	33.4	29.0

<i>Graduate Degree</i>	23.1	15.6	28.6	27.0
Family Income***				
<\$25K	14.8	25.5	9.8	13.2
\$25K-39.9K	9.9	15.3	7.7	9.9
\$40K-59.9K	11.4	15.3	12.2	13.0
\$60K-74.9K	9.8	10.9	10.2	10.8
\$75K-99.9K	12.3	10.9	14.4	13.6
\$100K-149.9K	17.8	10.9	19.1	18.7
>\$150K	24.0	11.3	26.6	20.9
Region				
<i>Midwest</i>	22.3	28.4	24.9	24.9
<i>Northeast</i>	20.0	14.9	18.5	16.4
<i>South</i>	35.1	37.5	35.3	36.6
<i>West</i>	22.6	19.3	21.4	22.2
Language***				
<i>English</i>	97.7	94.9	98.6	98.3
<i>Spanish</i>	2.3	5.1	1.4	1.7
Respondent Type***				
<i>Regular Responder</i>	53.2	52.4	64.6	64.3
<i>Irregular Responder</i>	17.0	9.1	6.0	3.0
<i>Replenishment</i>	29.9	38.6	29.5	32.8
<i>Sample Member</i>				

Note: *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; Percents may not sum to 1.00 due to rounding error; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

Table A2. Odds Ratios for Consenting to Receive Texts Only (and Providing Phone Numbers) by Select Demographics for Respondents in Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (*N* = 9,600)

Age Category (55-64 ref.)	
18-24	0.80 (0.34)
25-34	0.72 (0.18)
35-44	1.15 (0.22)
45-54	0.90 (0.19)
65-74	0.78 (0.15)
75-84	0.63 (0.17)
85+	0.95 (0.41)
Sex (Female ref.)	
Male	0.90 (0.12)
Race/Ethnicity (White, non-Hispanic ref.)	
Black, non-Hispanic	1.32 (0.23)
Asian, non-Hispanic	0.86 (0.28)
SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic	1.22 (0.39)
Hispanic/Latino	1.00 (0.22)
Marital Status (Now Married ref.)	
Domestic Partnership	1.08 (0.32)
Widowed	2.61*** (0.58)
Divorced	1.26 (0.24)
Separated	1.47 (0.58)
Never Married	1.31 (0.25)
Education Level (Bachelor's Degree ref.)	
< HS Diploma	2.60**

	(0.76)
HS Diploma/GED	2.07***
	(0.42)
Some College	1.61*
	(0.32)
Associate's Degree	1.51
	(0.37)
Graduate Degree	1.04
	(0.22)
Family Income (>\$150K ref.)	
<\$25K	2.09**
	(0.55)
\$25K-39.9K	1.89*
	(0.52)
\$40K-59.9K	1.61
	(0.42)
\$60K-74.9K	1.59
	(0.43)
\$75K-99.9K	1.30
	(0.35)
\$100K-149.9K	1.08
	(0.28)
Region (South ref.)	
Midwest	1.20
	(0.19)
Northeast	0.94
	(0.18)
West	0.94
	(0.17)
Survey Language (English ref.)	
Spanish	2.29*
	(0.81)
Respondent Type (Regular Responder ref.)	
Irregular Responder	1.61*
	(0.37)
Replenishment Sample Member	1.45**
	(0.19)
Constant	0.01***
	(0.00)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses; *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; ref. = reference group; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

Table A3. Odds Ratios for Consenting to Receive Emails Only (and Providing Email Addresses) by Select Demographics for Respondents in Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (*N* = 9,600)

Age Category (55-64 ref.)	
18-24	1.09 (0.17)
25-34	0.87 (0.07)
35-44	0.96 (0.07)
45-54	1.08 (0.08)
65-74	0.91 (0.06)
75-84	0.79* (0.07)
85+	1.48* (0.27)
Sex (Female ref.)	
Male	1.04 (0.05)
Race/Ethnicity (White, non-Hispanic ref.)	
Black, non-Hispanic	0.83* (0.06)
Asian, non-Hispanic	1.04 (0.09)
SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic	0.72** (0.09)
Hispanic/Latino	0.80** (0.06)
Marital Status (Now Married ref.)	
Domestic Partnership	0.89 (0.09)
Widowed	0.65*** (0.07)
Divorced	0.89 (0.06)
Separated	0.66* (0.12)
Never Married	1.06 (0.07)
Education Level (Bachelor's Degree ref.)	
< HS Diploma	0.75

HS Diploma/GED	(0.11) 0.82** (0.06)
Some College	0.77*** (0.05)
Associate's Degree	0.92 (0.08)
Graduate Degree	0.92 (0.05)
Family Income (>\$150K ref.)	
<\$25K	0.69*** (0.06)
\$25K-39.9K	0.76** (0.07)
\$40K-59.9K	0.88 (0.07)
\$60K-74.9K	0.86 (0.07)
\$75K-99.9K	0.94 (0.07)
\$100K-149.9K	0.87* (0.06)
Region (South ref.)	
Midwest	1.00 (0.06)
Northeast	1.07 (0.07)
West	0.97 (0.06)
Survey Language (English ref.)	
Spanish	0.99 (0.18)
Respondent Type (Regular Responder ref.)	
Irregular Responder	1.18 (0.11)
Replenishment Sample Member	0.87** (0.04)
Constant	0.93 (0.08)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses; *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; ref. = reference group; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.

Table A4. Odds Ratios for Consenting to Receive Both Texts and Emails (and Providing Phone Numbers and Email Addresses) by Select Demographics for Respondents in Topical 7 of the Census Household Panel, 2024 (*N* = 9,600)

Age Category (55-64 ref.)	
18-24	0.93 (0.15)
25-34	1.03 (0.08)
35-44	0.87* (0.06)
45-54	0.88 (0.06)
65-74	1.18* (0.08)
75-84	1.35*** (0.12)
85+	0.58** (0.11)
Sex (Female ref.)	
Male	0.98 (0.04)
Race/Ethnicity (White, non-Hispanic ref.)	
Black, non-Hispanic	1.22** (0.09)
Asian, non-Hispanic	0.76** (0.07)
SOR/Multiracial, non-Hispanic	1.09 (0.13)
Hispanic/Latino	1.12 (0.08)
Marital Status (Now Married ref.)	
Domestic Partnership	1.19 (0.11)
Widowed	1.21* (0.12)
Divorced	1.05 (0.07)
Separated	1.26 (0.22)
Never Married	0.97 (0.06)
Education Level (Bachelor's Degree ref.)	
< HS Diploma	0.91

	(0.13)
HS Diploma/GED	1.02
	(0.07)
Some College	1.16*
	(0.07)
Associate's Degree	1.02
	(0.08)
Graduate Degree	1.14*
	(0.06)
Family Income (>\$150K ref.)	
<\$25K	1.32**
	(0.12)
\$25K-39.9K	1.22*
	(0.11)
\$40K-59.9K	1.17
	(0.09)
\$60K-74.9K	1.16
	(0.09)
\$75K-99.9K	1.10
	(0.08)
\$100K-149.9K	1.18*
	(0.08)
Region (South ref.)	
Midwest	0.98
	(0.05)
Northeast	0.88*
	(0.05)
West	1.04
	(0.06)
Survey Language (English ref.)	
Spanish	0.90
	(0.16)
Respondent Type (Regular Responder ref.)	
Irregular Responder	0.34***
	(0.04)
Replenishment Sample Member	1.06
	(0.05)
Constant	0.82*
	(0.07)

Note: Standard errors in parentheses; *** p<0.001, ** p<0.01, * p<0.05; ref. = reference group; Sample sizes and number of respondents have been rounded to align with the Census Bureau's disclosure avoidance protection.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Census Household Panel Baseline and Topical 7 Surveys.